

MARKETING SWEET · ROLEPLAY 05

The Assumption Close

Session tie-in: Session 05 — Discipline is the Multiplier, You're the Operator Now

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~12 min · **Reps required:** 2

The setup

You're in the back office of **Tony Maluti's** showroom. Tony owns *Maluti Custom Homes* — 22 staff, ~\$5M turnover, builds high-end residential. He's a confident, slightly impatient decision-maker who runs a tight operation. He doesn't waffle and he doesn't expect you to.

You've spent 55 minutes pitching a \$9,500 SEO + content + landing-page package. Affordability — checked (he's named numbers bigger than this in the conversation). Intent — confirmed (he opened the meeting saying "we know we need to fix our digital, just need to find the right partner"). Likability — you've built solid rapport, found out he's a Crows supporter, swapped stories about Mount Pleasant pub.

You just said the price. Tony hasn't flinched. He's leaning back in his chair, hands behind his head.

You are the rep. Tony just said:

TONY: Yeah. Yeah, that sounds about right for the scope.

Coaching note — before you start: This is the moment most reps blow the close. They feel the deal is "almost there" and helpfully ask "so would you like to proceed?" or "want to think it over?" Both questions REOPEN the close. The session 05 lesson is: skip the close question entirely. Go straight to logistics. Default the conversation to yes.

THE SCRIPT

REP: Mate, brilliant. Tony — what I'll do is send you the link in the next ten minutes. All I need from you today is a deposit — \$2,500 — which gets us locked in. The full kick-off call we usually run in week one. Looking at next week, Tuesday or Wednesday work better for that — your call?

Coaching note: Notice three things. One — you didn't ASK if he wanted to proceed. You assumed it and moved to logistics. Two — the deposit ask is specific (\$2,500), so there's no fuzziness about what "lock it in" means. Three — you offered him a binary choice on the kick-off (Tuesday or Wednesday), not an open question ("when works for you?") that would force him to think and likely drift.

TONY: Wednesday. Mornings are better for me.

REP: Perfect. Wednesday morning. I'll send a calendar invite for 10am with the kick-off agenda — usually that's a 30-min run-through of brand assets, content priorities, and the first batch of keywords we're going to target. Bring [name of relevant person in his business] if you want them involved from day one.

TONY: Yep, my GM will be on it.

REP: Brilliant. The link for the deposit — I'll text it to you in the next ten minutes. Once that lands, we're locked in and the team starts on the keyword and competitor research that afternoon. Sound good?

TONY: Sound good. Send the link.

Coaching note: That's a close. The total time from "yeah, sounds about right" to "send the link" was ~30 seconds. No re-opening, no "are you sure?", no "do you want to think it over?" The default of the conversation was yes, you kept it there, and Tony said yes.

THE FORK — Tony tries to slow it down:

TONY: Yeah, mate — sounds good. Let me run it past Mark, my partner, and I'll get back to you in a few days.

Coaching note: This is the most common deal-slow on confident decision-makers — the partner/colleague reference. Don't push back hard. Don't dismiss it. Use the Session 01 + Session 04 hybrid: treat it as a buying signal, not an objection, but anchor the next step.

REP: Mate, totally — partner alignment matters. Quick question: when you run it past Mark — is there anything specific you want to clarify with him, like budget approval, or is it more a "let's both be on the same page" thing?

TONY: It's a "both on the same page" thing.

REP: Cool. In that case — and tell me if this is forward — let me do something. I'll send you the link tonight. If Mark's onboard, you can just lock it in. If he flags something, no problem, you ring me before signing and we'll address it. Reverses your timeline a bit — you said a few days, I'm giving you four. Sound fair?

TONY: [Pause] Yeah alright, send it through.

Coaching note: That's the Session 01 spousal-approval play applied to a business partner. You reframed the delay (a few days became four), gave him the tool to act fast (the link is in his inbox now), removed the friction (Mark flags it → easy out), and didn't force him into commitment. He'll close in 80%+ of cases. The ones that don't close — find out *why* on the follow-up call and run the diagnostic.

THE SECOND FORK — Tony tries to negotiate on price:

TONY: Yeah look, the scope's good. Can you do \$8,500? Round number, makes my life easier.

Coaching note: First — don't fold instantly. Second — don't refuse instantly. Probe the verbal commit (Session 04). Don't go to the office without one.

REP: Mate, I'd need to look at it. Before I do — if I can get you to a better number, are you signing today?

TONY: Yeah, if you can do \$8,500 I'll sign now.

REP: Okay. I'll see what I can do. I'm not going to pretend the office will say yes — but I'll fight for \$8,750 with the deposit locked in this afternoon. Round number a little odd, but the price tells you it's the genuine best I could do. Sound fair?

TONY: \$8,750 — yeah, alright. Send the link.

Coaching note: The session 01 odd-number close (\$8,750 vs the round \$8,500). Round prices say "I had room." Odd prices say "I genuinely squeezed every drop." Tony will accept this faster than \$8,500 because it FEELS like the real bottom.

STRETCH VARIATIONS

- **Tony says "send me a written proposal and I'll come back."** This is a drift signal. Probe before complying — "I can send a proposal, no problem. Just curious — what would you want in writing that we haven't already covered today?" Often the request collapses when you ask the question; the prospect realises they don't actually have a reason for the delay.
 - **Tony says "great, I'm in" and asks for the link.** Don't celebrate. Skip straight to the kick-off scheduling — momentum is critical. The window between "yes" and "let me actually do this" is small.
 - **Tony asks about cancellation policy mid-close.** Address it briefly and confidently — don't dwell. "Standard month-to-month after the initial term. 30 days' notice. Hasn't come up much because the work delivers, but the option's there if it ever doesn't." Then back to logistics.
-

WHAT TO LOOK FOR WHEN YOU'RE PRACTISING THIS

- Did the rep ask "would you like to proceed?" or jump straight to logistics?
- Did they specify the deposit amount, or were they fuzzy?
- Did they give Tony a binary choice on the kick-off (Tuesday/Wednesday), or an open question?
- When Tony deferred to his partner, did the rep give him the easy out OR push too hard?

- When Tony asked for \$8,500, did the rep fold, refuse, or trade?

This is the cleanest close in the playbook. If a rep can run this one well, they can probably also run Sessions 01 and 04 well — it's the same conviction muscle.